

Editorial

Dear readers,

The good news first—we launched FOSSYellowPages.com (beta) on the 20th of May, 2010.

The project had started off with a listing of about 20 solutions providers in *LINUX For You* magazine. Soon, the listing grew to over 100 firms from India. However, within a few months of the launch, it was clear that an online edition of the same would be more beneficial. The solutions providers were techies; so were the CIOs and IT managers looking for them; and all had access to the Internet. Plus, we could provide features in the online version that the print edition could not offer. For one, you can now directly add your firm to the listings. CIOs and IT heads on the look out for solutions providers for a particular open source project in a particular city, can easily do so now. The list of solutions providers is now categorised under different heads—open source projects, the type of technology solutions, countries, cities and towns. Besides, there are many more features in the offing.

And before I forget to mention it, all open source solutions providers can list themselves for FREE. There's a lot more about this venture that we wanted to share with you, so we decided to 'interview ourselves'—yes, we interviewed the LFY team! So here's presenting to you FOSSYellowPages.com. Turn to Page 74 to know more about how you can use this portal to attract global as well as Indian customers.

The last month also saw us interacting with different stake holders from the open source database world—Ingres, MySQL and PostgreSQL. It was quite a coincidence, if you ask me, to meet the global leaders of Ingres, plus a key Indian partner of MySQL, and participate in a detailed teleconference with the Indian head of a firm promoting PostgreSQL—all within days of each other.

While the purpose of each of those conversations was entirely different, one topic remained common—how is MySQL doing after Oracle acquired Sun Microsystems (and got MySQL as part of the package)? The response

was unanimous—MySQL's image, community involvement and customer-demand, have all been hit. Customers are shifting from MySQL, since they are not convinced about the technology road-map for it. The MySQL community is confused, since it is no longer clear whether its members are working for the world's fastest growing open source database or for Oracle.

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One wonders if there's something that we, as a community, can learn from the MySQL episode? Perhaps the answer lies in what I overheard a colleague say, "Open source projects that are not promoted by a single firm, like Debian, will never face the risk of an acquisition."

"But then, can such projects grow fast and become a commercial success?" was the prompt response from another colleague. There are a few examples of these, but I hope that future issues of LFY will be able to carry features that offer a better reply to that question.

Best wishes,



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PS: The first 200 firms that apply for the 'Verify Contact Details' option on FOSSYellowPages.com, get it for FREE. At the time of going to press, we had crossed 105.